ZACHARY TURNER

Software Engineer | WordPress VIP, Gutenberg, React & TypeScript | Marketing & Content Platforms
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack web developer with 8 years of experience, including 4 years specializing in enterprise WordPress on the WordPress VIP platform. Builds custom Gutenberg blocks, themes, and plugins from scratch in React, TypeScript, and PHP for high-traffic sports and media platforms serving millions of monthly users. Owned a full Drupal-to-WordPress migration end to end, and built the analytics, ad delivery, and marketing automation layer those platforms depend on, including Google Tag Manager, Google Ad Manager, and Salesforce Marketing Cloud integrations. Background spans headless CMS work with GraphQL, Angular front-ends, REST API development, and agency delivery, with a published React/TypeScript design system demonstrating token architecture, Storybook, and CI-enforced accessibility. Comfortable across the stack, from PHP backends to editor-facing tooling, working alongside product, design, marketing, and QA.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

WordPress: WordPress VIP, Custom Gutenberg Block Development (block.json, theme.json, block patterns, variations), Plugin & Theme Architecture, WP-CLI, VIP CLI, Headless WordPress, Editor Experience Design

Frontend: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Angular, Semantic HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, CSS Modules, Twig, jQuery, Responsive & Mobile-First Design

Backend & APIs: PHP, Node.js, REST APIs, GraphQL, OAuth, Nonce Security, Transients API Caching

Marketing Technology: Google Tag Manager, Google Analytics, Google Ad Manager, Data Layer Implementation, Salesforce Marketing Cloud, Pardot, Form Architecture & Lead Capture, Conversion Tracking

Design Systems: Storybook, Chromatic, Design Tokens (DTCG), Component Library Architecture, Figma-to-Code, Visual Regression Testing

Standards & Performance: WCAG 2.1 AA Accessibility, Core Web Vitals, Web Performance Optimization, Cross-Browser Compatibility

CMS Migrations: Drupal 9, Drupal-to-WordPress Migration, Content Modeling, Automated HTML-to-Block Transformation

Tooling & Infra: Git, SVN, Composer, Webpack, Vite, Jest, Docker, Lando, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), AWS (Lambda, S3, CloudFront), Jira, Confluence, Agile/Scrum

AI Workflow: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, AI-assisted development and code review

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Versant, Software Engineer | Aug 2025 – Present

Continuation of NBC Sports Next role following corporate spinoff; same platform and team.

- Engineer on a WordPress VIP multisite platform serving SportsEngine and GolfNow, spanning 2,500+ subsites and millions of monthly users across consumer and B2B audiences.
- Designed and built 30–40 custom Gutenberg blocks from scratch using React, TypeScript, and block.json, including dynamic navigation carousels, content aggregators, geolocation search tools, and promotional engines, built for reuse across 4+ multisite properties.
- Built 8 custom WordPress themes from scratch and maintained 20+ more, using shared SCSS design systems that cut per-site duplication and sped up new property onboarding.
- Built the analytics and ad delivery layer into the block system, embedding Google Tag Manager containers, Google Ad Manager slots, and data layer events directly into reusable Gutenberg blocks so tracking ships correctly by default rather than being retrofitted per page.
- Implemented Salesforce Marketing Cloud form integrations across site properties, handling submission routing, validation, and user-level conversion tracking for marketing campaigns.
- Troubleshot and resolved data tracking failures across properties, diagnosing tag misfires, data layer gaps, and measurement discrepancies with marketing and analytics stakeholders.
- Focused on editor experience: built block controls, variations, and patterns that let non-technical editors assemble accessible, on-brand pages without developer support.
- Partnered with UX and creative teams to translate Figma designs into production Gutenberg blocks, building responsive, accessible components that held up to the design system across breakpoints and content variations.

- Implemented secure, high-performance REST API integrations with nonce validation, Transients API caching, and dynamic location-based search endpoints serving real-time consumer requests.
- Managed Composer dependency workflows, VIP code scanning remediation, CI pipeline configuration, and debugging across local, staging, and production environments.
- Onboarded newer developers, participated in peer code reviews, and worked with product, design, and QA to ship on tight launch timelines.
- Used AI tooling (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT) to speed up plugin development and code reviews without sacrificing quality.

NBC Sports Next, Software Engineer | Aug 2021 – Aug 2025

- Built the Drupal-to-WordPress VIP migration via a custom plugin handling content model mapping, taxonomy restructuring, media imports, and automated HTML-to-block transformations of thousands of posts.
- Developed and maintained custom WordPress themes and plugins using PHP, JavaScript, and Bootstrap, delivering responsive, cross-browser experiences for large sports and media audiences.
- Helped transition a headless Drupal application to an Angular front-end, integrating GraphQL for data fetching and writing unit tests and QA coverage for the new front-end.
- Built custom Drupal components and modules for consumer-facing SportsEngine and GolfNow properties prior to the WordPress migration, covering templating, theming, and interactive front-end behavior.
- Worked directly with designers and UX to turn Figma and Photoshop files into working, responsive features, flagging technical constraints early and iterating through design review.
- Worked in Agile environments and performed peer code reviews across multiple concurrent workstreams.

SportsEngine, Front-End Developer | Dec 2018 – Aug 2021

- Primary developer on the GolfNow B2B Drupal site, owning day-to-day maintenance, bug triage and resolution, and the build-out of custom content types and field configurations that gave marketing and content teams more control over their pages.
- Built and maintained custom Drupal content types, views, and Twig-templated components across SportsEngine and GolfNow, laying the content architecture that informed the later WordPress VIP migration.
- Developed responsive, accessible landing pages and campaign experiences across consumer and B2B properties using PHP, Angular, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS, working to campaign deadlines alongside marketing stakeholders.
- Produced Salesforce Marketing Cloud campaign assets and email templates, connecting landing page capture to downstream marketing automation.
- Extended and themed custom Drupal CMS components to match design specs across multiple properties.

Martin Williams, Front-End Developer | May 2016 – Nov 2018

- Built custom WordPress themes from scratch using PHP, JavaScript, and Bootstrap for advertising and marketing clients across multiple industries, working at agency pace on concurrent campaigns.
- Developed reusable custom post types, ACF field groups, and template hierarchies to support structured, editor-friendly content management.
- Built lead capture forms and responsive email campaigns (Litmus, Pardot, Salesforce Marketing Cloud) plus interactive HTML5 banner ads; led QA and cross-browser validation.

ICF Next, Software Engineer Intern | Jan 2016 – Mar 2016

- Built AngularJS and Node.js features for internal enterprise applications in a Scrum team alongside UX designers.

EDUCATION

Prime Digital Academy — Full-Stack Software Engineering Certificate, 2015

University of Kansas — BS Psychology, Minor in Film, 2010